

Documentation

Review & Reflect

I enjoyed collecting my own data and finding patterns in it. Tracking how I felt every time I picked up my phone made the experiment feel personal, not just something for class. I noticed I often picked up my phone out of boredom or habit rather than happiness, which was surprising.

The most meaningful part was becoming more aware of my everyday behaviour. I don't usually think about why I use my phone, but this showed me it's often automatic. Turning my emotions into data helped me reflect on my habits more clearly.

I'm interested in exploring the datafication of everyday life further, especially more creative ways to represent emotions using visuals like colour. This project also showed me that data isn't fully objective, because how I labelled emotions shaped the results.

Overall, I want to keep using data in a more personal and creative way to show real human experiences.

Thematic Process

For my design project, I want to explore everyday phone habits and how they connect to emotions. People often pick up their phones automatically when they feel bored, tired, anxious, or just out of habit, without really thinking about it.

A future scenario I want to explore is automated habit-tracking for wellbeing. In this idea, phones wouldn't just track how often we use them, but also how we feel when we do. Over time, the system could recognise patterns, like someone constantly using their phone when they're bored or stressed, and then suggest ways to change those habits.

The data I'll use is self-collected emotional data from my own phone use. I'll record emotions like happy, bored, tired, and FOMO each time I pick up my phone. This data doesn't already exist in a structured form, so I need to collect it myself. It will mostly be static data over time, but I could also imagine it as live data in a future app.

I'll interpret the data by looking for patterns, such as which emotions happen most and when. This could show how phone use is driven by emotion rather than purpose. It also connects to ideas from class about how data isn't fully objective and how everyday life can be turned into data. Overall, the project aims to make invisible habits visible through simple but meaningful data.

Visualisation & Impact

For my project, I want to create a visualisation of my phone-use emotions over time using colour to represent different feelings, like blue for tired, yellow for happy, and red for stress. This could be shown as a timeline or map that builds patterns people can easily understand, with possible interactive layers to explore specific moments or overall habits.

The aim is to make people reflect on how automatic phone use is and how emotions influence it without us realising. I want the audience to have a moment of recognition and become more aware of their own habits through visible, personal data.

AI Usage Statement

I have used chatgpt to find some ideas of a direction that I could take my exploration and hopefully deepen my understanding on an area that I am interested in.

OpenAI. (2024). ChatGPT (April 23 version) [Large language model]. <https://chat.openai.com/chat>.